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Proposed programme budget for 2027

Programme planning

Proposed programme budget for 2027

Part II

Political affairs

Section 6

Peaceful uses of outer space

Programme 5

Peaceful uses of outer space

Contents

	<i>Page</i>
A. Proposed programme plan for 2027 and programme performance in 2025***	2
Overall orientation	2
Programme of work	2

* The present document (A/81/6 (Sect. 6)/Part A), consisting of the programme plan and programme performance information (part II; see General Assembly resolution [77/267](#), para. 10), will be replaced by a document containing parts A and B (A/81/6 (Sect. 6)) once part B is issued.

** [A/81/50](#).

*** In keeping with paragraph 10 of General Assembly resolution [77/267](#), the part consisting of the programme plan and programme performance information (part II) is submitted through the Committee for Programme and Coordination for the consideration of the Assembly.



A. Proposed programme plan for 2027 and programme performance in 2025

Overall orientation

Mandates and background

- 6.1 The Office for Outer Space Affairs is responsible for advancing international cooperation in space activities. The mandate derives from relevant General Assembly resolutions and decisions, including resolutions [1472 A \(XIV\)](#), [76/3](#), entitled “The ‘Space2030’ Agenda: space as a driver of sustainable development”, [80/76](#) on international cooperation in the peaceful uses of outer space and [80/44](#) on transparency and confidence-building measures in outer space activities, as appropriate.
- 6.2 The core functions of the Office are: (a) serving as the secretariat of the Committee on the Peaceful Uses of Outer Space and its subsidiary bodies (resolution [1472 A \(XIV\)](#)), as the executive secretariat of the International Committee on Global Navigation Satellite Systems and its Providers’ Forum (resolutions [61/111](#) and [64/86](#)) and as the secretariat of the Space Mission Planning Advisory Group (resolution [71/90](#)); (b) implementing the United Nations Programme on Space Applications (resolutions [2601 \(XXIV\)](#) and [37/90](#)) and the programme on the United Nations Platform for Space-based Information for Disaster Management and Emergency Response (UN-SPIDER) (resolution [61/110](#)); (c) maintaining the Register of Objects Launched into Outer Space (resolutions [1721 B \(XVI\)](#) and [3235 \(XXIX\)](#)); (d) discharging the responsibilities of the Secretary-General under the United Nations treaties and principles on outer space and related resolutions (resolutions [2222 \(XXI\)](#), [2345 \(XXII\)](#), [2777 \(XXVI\)](#), [3235 \(XXIX\)](#), [34/68](#), [37/92](#), [41/65](#), [47/68](#), [59/115](#) and [62/101](#)); and (e) supporting Member States in fulfilling the “Space2030” Agenda implementation plan (resolution [76/3](#)).

Programme of work

Peaceful uses of outer space

Objective

- 6.3 The objective, to which this programme contributes, is to strengthen international cooperation in the conduct of space activities for peaceful purposes and advance the use of space science and technology and their applications.

Strategy and external factors for 2027

- 6.4 To contribute to the objective, the Office will support the work of the Committee on the Peaceful Uses of Outer Space and its subsidiary bodies and promote international cooperation in the exploration and use of outer space for peaceful purposes. Specifically, the Office will:
- (a) Provide substantive secretariat services to the Committee, the Scientific and Technical Subcommittee, the Legal Subcommittee, the International Committee on Global Navigation Satellite Systems and its Providers’ Forum and the Space Mission Planning Advisory Group;
 - (b) Provide secretariat services to the working groups of the Committee and its subsidiary bodies, including the Working Groups on Legal Aspects of Space Resource Activities and on the Long-term Sustainability of Outer Space Activities, the Action Team on Lunar Activities Consultation and the Expert Group on Space Situational Awareness;
 - (c) Work with Member States, intergovernmental and, where relevant and applicable, non-governmental entities and other partners to promote the peaceful use of outer space, including through: (i) the implementation of the international legal framework governing space activities;

- (ii) the registration of space objects launched into outer space; (iii) space debris mitigation; (iv) transparency and confidence-building measures in outer space activities, as appropriate; (v) civil satellite-based positioning, navigation, timing and value added services; and (vi) assistance to the Committee in further developing the governance of outer space activities;
- (d) Deliver training events and technical advisory support to assist States, upon their request, and institutions in: (i) enhancing capacities in areas such as space law and policy, space sustainability, space economy, climate change, environmental monitoring, natural resources management, precision farming and agriculture, water resources, oceans, global health, satellite communications, education, space weather, space exploration, astronomy, search and rescue, disaster risk reduction and emergency response, and global navigation satellite systems; and (ii) developing collaborative platforms and promoting knowledge-sharing for space-based solutions;
- (e) Enhance key initiatives, such as the United Nations Space Bridge, the United Nations Space Sustainability Days and the United Nations Space Debates, to build the capacity of member States of the Committee and facilitate implementation of the international legal framework governing space activities in the lead-up to the convening of the Fourth United Nations Conference on the Exploration and Peaceful Uses of Outer Space (UNISPACE IV);
- (f) Cooperate with the regional centres for space science and technology education affiliated to the United Nations to deliver capacity-building activities and training in space science and technology to support Member States in achieving the Sustainable Development Goals;
- (g) Augment the impact of the work of the Committee and the Office on progress towards achieving the Sustainable Development Goals, through: (i) targeted outreach activities, publications and materials; (ii) exchanges with relevant stakeholders to promote more systematic sharing of space-based data and information to foster sustainable development and space sustainability; (iii) promotion of the widest possible adherence to, and full compliance with, the Treaty on Principles Governing the Activities of States in the Exploration and Use of Outer Space, including the Moon and Other Celestial Bodies, and of the role of the Committee in discussions on the establishment of new frameworks for space traffic, space debris and space resources; and (iv) the conduct of activities complementary to the work of the Committee and its working groups, including on the Pact for the Future;
- (h) Provide support to Member States that express interest in Committee membership with a view to increasing access to space solutions, partnerships and capacity-building, and participation in the governance of outer space activities.

6.5 The above-mentioned work is expected to result in:

- (a) A safer and more sustainable outer space;
- (b) Space-based solutions enabling monitoring of and progress towards the achievement of the Sustainable Development Goals;
- (c) Greater understanding, acceptance and application of the international legal framework governing space activities;
- (d) An increased number of countries with access to space and space benefits, in particular developing countries, in using science and technology and related applications, including space-based solutions, to achieve sustainable development, disaster risk reduction and emergency response;
- (e) Greater compatibility and interoperability of global navigation satellite systems;
- (f) Space capabilities being more readily available through strengthened cooperative relationships and new partnerships.

6.6 With regard to the external factors, the overall plan for 2027 is based on the planning assumption that governmental, intergovernmental and non-governmental organizations are able and willing to support the Office in implementing the programme and responding to increased requests for assistance from Member States.

- 6.7 With regard to cooperation with other entities at the global, regional, national and local levels, the Office will, in line with its mandate, pursue new opportunities with established governmental, intergovernmental and non-governmental partners, including space agencies, industry, academia, institutions and other space-related entities, to strengthen the capacity of countries, in particular developing countries, in using space science and technology and their applications. The Office will also pursue cooperative relationships, including with the private sector. It will enhance transparency by regularly informing the Committee of the projects being implemented and of its partnerships with space agencies, governmental and non-governmental organizations and the private sector.
- 6.8 With regard to inter-agency coordination and liaison, the Office will lead the Inter-Agency Meeting on Outer Space Activities (UN-Space) to promote coherence and increase collaboration on space-related work among entities of the United Nations system, including through an inter-agency hub for procurement of earth observation imagery, with a view to better coordinating data-sharing and cooperation on the procurement of space-based information.
- 6.9 The Office integrates a gender perspective into its operational activities, deliverables and results, as appropriate. The Office will work with partners to continue implementing its Space for Women project to strengthen the capacity and skills of individuals and institutions, with an emphasis on enhancing the participation and retention of women and girls in space activities.
- 6.10 In line with the United Nations Disability Inclusion Strategy, the Office will promote inclusive practices for the employment of persons with disabilities in the space sector.

Adjustments arising from the UN80 Initiative

- 6.11 The proposed programme plan for 2027 reflects changes arising from the UN80 Initiative. In particular, the table of deliverables reflects updated planned deliverables for 2026, in line with the approved programme budget for 2026. For example, workshops, training activities and advisory missions on related themes will be consolidated, and virtual modalities used where appropriate. Updates to e-learning tools, databases, the Register of Objects Launched into Outer Space and the Online Index of Objects Launched into Outer Space will be adjusted in terms of scope, while parliamentary documentation will be optimized for timeliness and efficiency.
- 6.12 The Office will be guided by any future decisions taken in the context of the UN80 Initiative, in accordance with the applicable rules and procedures, including decisions, resolutions and established practice of the competent intergovernmental organs.

Evaluation activities

- 6.13 An evaluation of the Space for Water Project, conducted by the Office and completed in 2025, has guided the proposed programme plan for 2027.
- 6.14 In response to the results of the evaluation referenced above, the Office will adjust the activities under the Space for Water Project to be more targeted, with a focus on enhancing impact at the regional and local levels and engaging a wider array of beneficiary groups.

Programme performance in 2025

Enhanced planning and preparedness for potentially hazardous near-Earth objects

- 6.15 Recognizing the growing risk posed by high-impact natural hazards from space and the need for advance preparedness, the programme facilitated multi-stakeholder engagement on potentially hazardous near-Earth objects at the international Planetary Defense Conference held in 2025 in South Africa. The engagement included a hands-on simulation exercise of a hypothetical asteroid impact scenario, bringing together experts from space agencies, national authorities and regional and international organizations in Southern Africa. It introduced disaster managers and responders to

internationally established early warning and information-sharing mechanisms and protocols. The need for planning for cross-border and cascading impacts, coordination and decision-making across national boundaries was emphasized, and the exercise focused on detection, uncertainty management, civil protection actions and post-impact responses.

6.16 Progress towards the objective is presented in the performance measure below (see table 6.1).

Table 6.1
Performance measure

2023 (actual)	2024 (actual)	2025 (actual)
—	—	Enhanced preparedness in Africa for potentially hazardous near-Earth objects through improved information-sharing that supports effective emergency response and disaster management

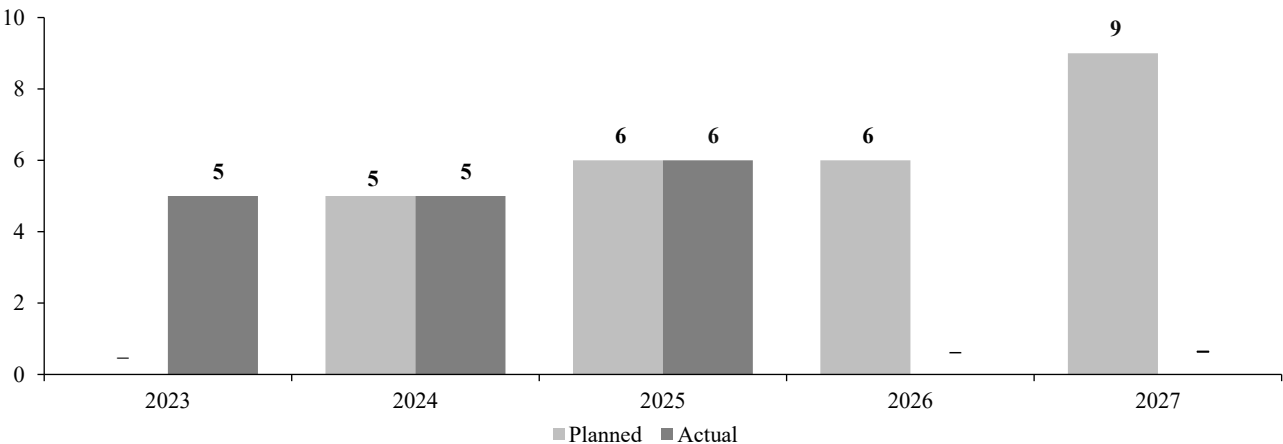
Planned results for 2027

Result 1: increased access to space

Programme performance in 2025 and target for 2027

- 6.17 The programme’s work contributed to the launch of one additional satellite through the Access to Space for All initiative, which met the planned target.
- 6.18 Progress towards the objective and the target for 2027 are presented in the performance measure below (see figure 6.I).

Figure 6.I
Performance measure: number of satellites launched into outer space through the Access to Space for All initiative (cumulative)

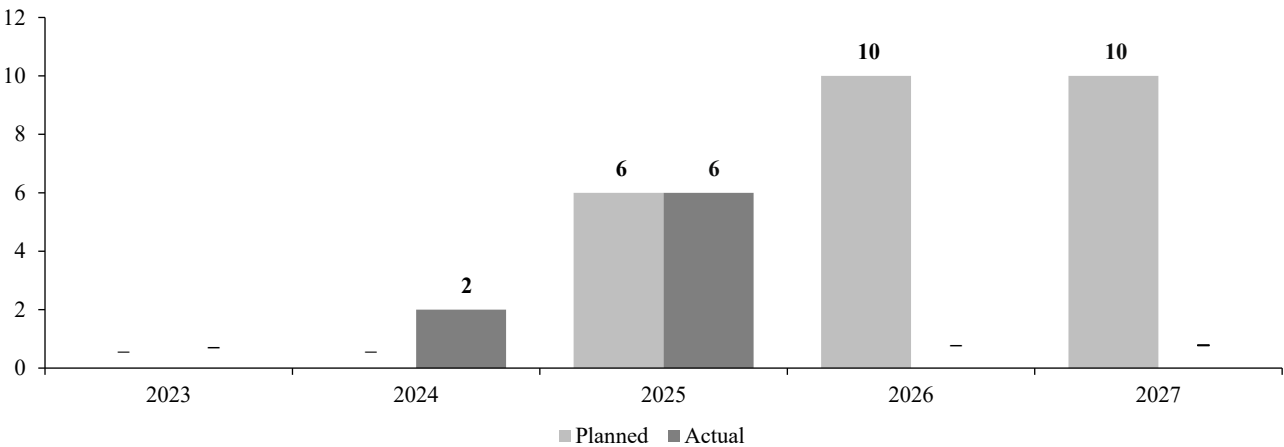


Result 2: greater access to space solutions, partnerships, capacity-building and involvement in governance of outer space activities

Programme performance in 2025 and target for 2027

- 6.19 The programme’s work contributed to six Member States applying to become members of the Committee on the Peaceful Uses of Outer Space, which met the planned target.
- 6.20 Progress towards the objective and the target for 2027 are presented in the performance measure below (see figure 6.II).

Figure 6.II
Performance measure: number of Member States applying to become members of the Committee on the Peaceful Uses of Outer Space (annual)



Result 3: increased use of space-based technology and data for disaster management and emergency response

Proposed programme plan for 2027

- 6.21 The use of digital technologies for disaster management and building resilience is an important resource for Member States in responding to and recovering from natural disasters and extreme weather events. The programme has supported Member States in this area through high-impact technical assistance, notably the 2024 pilot in Tonga, which utilized satellite-based models for sea level rise simulation. This work expanded in 2025 to Ghana and Trinidad and Tobago, where artificial intelligence-driven three-dimensional models were deployed to visualize urban flood risks and infrastructure vulnerability, demonstrating the practical utility of space data in national preparedness.

Lessons learned and planned change

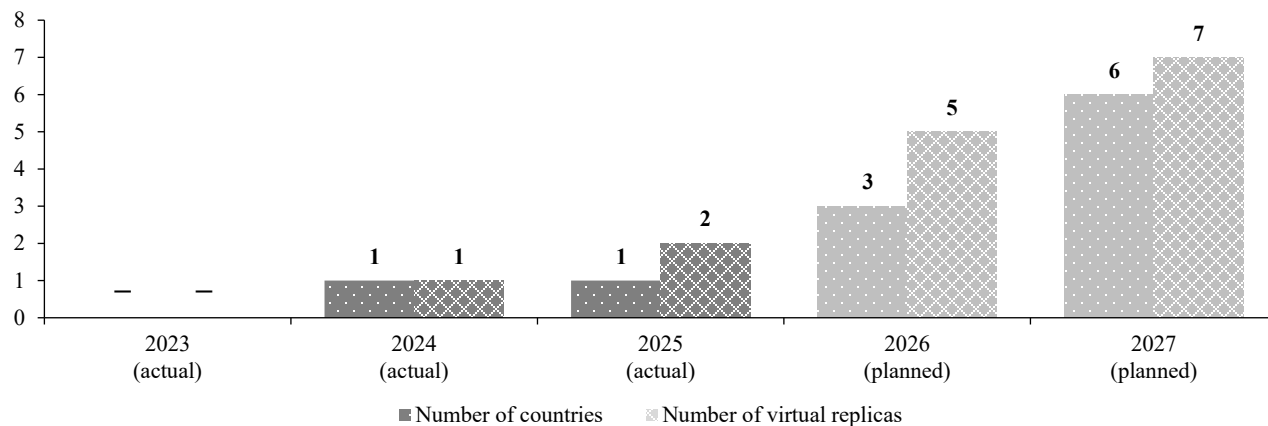
- 6.22 The lesson for the programme was that traditional disaster mapping tools often lack the predictive depth required for complex scenarios, leading to high demand among Member States for more sophisticated, integrative technologies. In applying the lesson, the programme will facilitate the development and delivery to requesting Member States of virtual three-dimensional replicas of geographic regions vulnerable to natural disasters. Pilot projects have demonstrated that real-time virtual replicas, often referred to as “digital twin models”, can better support disaster preparedness, as they allow for dynamic “what-if” simulations that two-dimensional data cannot provide. The programme will also facilitate the integration of satellite-based data and simulation videos to support the inclusion of these models into national preparedness processes in order to support early warning and risk management. To ensure sustainability, the programme will integrate standardized data protocols and simulation workflows by embedding them directly into the standard operating procedures of national disaster management authorities, upon request. This systematic integration will

enable Member States to move beyond experimental use towards the autonomous, long-term application of three-dimensional virtual replicas for national early warning and disaster risk reduction.

6.23 Expected progress towards the objective is presented in the performance measure below (see figure 6.III).

Figure 6.III

Performance measure: number of Member States using space-based virtual replicas to support early warning, flood modelling or infrastructure risk assessments (annual)



Legislative mandates

6.24 The list below, which was reviewed in the preparation of the proposed programme budget, provides all mandates entrusted to the programme.

General Assembly resolutions

1472 A (XIV); 1721 B (XVI); 2601 (XXIV); 3234 (XXIX); 61/111; 64/86; 71/90; 74/82; 77/121; 79/87; 80/76	International cooperation in the peaceful uses of outer space	37/92	Principles Governing the Use by States of Artificial Earth Satellites for International Direct Television Broadcasting
2222 (XXI)	Treaty on Principles Governing the Activities of States in the Exploration and Use of Outer Space, including the Moon and Other Celestial Bodies	54/68	Principles Relating to Remote Sensing of the Earth from Outer Space
2345 (XXII)	Agreement on the Rescue of Astronauts, the Return of Astronauts and the Return of Objects Launched into Outer Space	59/2	Principles Relevant to the Use of Nuclear Power Sources in Outer Space
2777 (XXVI)	Convention on International Liability for Damage Caused by Space Objects	59/115	Third United Nations Conference on the Exploration and Peaceful Uses of Outer Space
3235 (XXIX)	Convention on Registration of Objects Launched into Outer Space	61/110	Review of the implementation of the recommendations of the Third United Nations Conference on the Exploration and Peaceful Uses of Outer Space
34/68	Agreement Governing the Activities of States on the Moon and Other Celestial Bodies	62/101	Application of the concept of the “launching State”
37/90	Second United Nations Conference on the Exploration and Peaceful Uses of Outer Space	65/271	United Nations Platform for Space-based Information for Disaster Management and Emergency Response
			Recommendations on enhancing the practice of States and international intergovernmental organizations in registering space objects
			International Day of Human Space Flight

Part II	Political affairs	
68/74	Recommendations on national legislation relevant to the peaceful exploration and use of outer space	76/3
69/283	Sendai Framework for Disaster Risk Reduction 2015–2030	77/120
70/1	Transforming our world: the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development	79/1
72/78	Declaration on the fiftieth anniversary of the Treaty on Principles Governing the Activities of States in the Exploration and Use of Outer Space, including the Moon and Other Celestial Bodies	79/86
73/6	Fiftieth anniversary of the first United Nations Conference on the Exploration and	79/226
		80/113
		Peaceful Uses of Outer Space: space as a driver of sustainable development
		The “Space2030” Agenda: space as a driver of sustainable development
		Space and global health
		The Pact for the Future
		International Year of Asteroid Awareness and Planetary Defence, 2029
		Quadrennial comprehensive policy review of operational activities for development of the United Nations system
		International cooperation on humanitarian assistance in the field of natural disasters, from relief to development

Deliverables

6.25 Table 6.2 lists all deliverables of the programme.

Table 6.2
Deliverables for the period 2025–2027, by category and subcategory

Category and subcategory	2025 planned	2025 actual	2026 planned ^a	2027 planned
A. Facilitation of the intergovernmental process and expert bodies				
Parliamentary documentation (number of documents)	105	103	84	95
1. Reports to the Committee on the Peaceful Uses of Outer Space, including its Scientific and Technical and Legal Subcommittees	105	103	84 [105]	95
Substantive services for meetings (number of three-hour meetings)	65	68	65	72
2. Meetings of the General Assembly	—	—	—	—
3. Meetings of the Fifth Committee	1	1	1	1
4. Meetings of the Committee for Programme and Coordination	1	1	1	1
5. Meetings of the Advisory Committee on Administrative and Budgetary Questions	1	1	1	1
6. Meetings of the Fourth Committee and its Working Group of the Whole on the agenda item entitled “International cooperation in the peaceful uses of outer space”	3	3	3	3
7. Meetings of the Committee on the Peaceful Uses of Outer Space, including its Scientific and Technical and Legal Subcommittees	56	52	56	56
8. Intersessional consultations of the Committee on the Peaceful Uses of Outer Space, including its Scientific and Technical and Legal Subcommittees	3	10	3	10
Conference and secretariat services for meetings (number of three-hour meetings)	14	18	15	16
9. Meetings of the International Committee on Global Navigation Satellite Systems and its Providers’ Forum	10	11	11	11
10. Meetings of the Space Mission Planning Advisory Group	4	7	4	5
B. Generation and transfer of knowledge				
Seminars, workshops and training events (number of days)	76	48	51	59
11. Training events on space law, policy, safety and sustainability, including for new space actors	17	11	10 [17]	14
12. Training events on space science and technology and their applications	24	20	20 [24]	20
13. Training events and technical advisory missions on the use of space technology in disaster management	24	14	16 [24]	16
14. World Space Forum	3	—	3	3

Section 6 Peaceful uses of outer space

Category and subcategory	2025 planned	2025 actual	2026 planned ^a	2027 planned
15. Planetary Defense Conference	3	–	–	–
16. Panels on Space for Women	3	1	1 [3]	3
17. Open forum for Member States and meetings of United Nations entities on the use of space technology	2	–	1	1
18. One Moon for All initiative	–	2	–	2
Publications (number of publications)	6	5	1	2
19. Publications on the Office's activities and the Committee on the Peaceful Uses of Outer Space	6	5	1	2
Technical materials (number of materials)	74	84	96	104
20. Information furnished in accordance with the United Nations treaties and principles on outer space	4	9	6	9
21. Information furnished in accordance with the Convention on Registration of Objects Launched into Outer Space and General Assembly resolution 1721 B (XVI)	70	75	90	95

C. Substantive deliverables

Consultation, advice and advocacy: normative support to meetings on the sustainability of space activities, the Working Group C of the International Committee on Global Navigation Satellite Systems and the Space for Women network; expert and tailored advice to Member States, upon request, on: the registration of space objects; space science and technology and their applications; activities of the United Nations-affiliated regional centres for space science and technology education; the use of space-based information in disaster management plans, policies and disaster risk management activities in approximately 6 Member States; and space-based information to support emergency and humanitarian response in at least 4 developing countries; the organization of long-term and other training opportunities in the field of space science and technology and related applications; and multi-stakeholder engagement on planning and preparedness for near-Earth object threats.

Databases and substantive digital materials: Register of Objects Launched into Outer Space and Online Index of Objects Launched into Outer Space, UN-SPIDER knowledge portal, International Committee on Global Navigation Satellite Systems portal, Space4Water portal, Space Solutions Compendium (database), platform for satellite imagery purchase coordination, data-sharing and analytics, e-learning courses and national space law collection.

D. Communication deliverables

Outreach programmes, special events and information materials: exhibits, promotional and educational materials, and celebrations of achievements and other anniversaries relating to outer space.

External and media relations: press releases and press conferences on the work of the Office and the Committee on the Peaceful Uses of Outer Space.

Digital platforms and multimedia content: websites, social media campaigns and explainer videos on outer space.

^a Reflects updated planned deliverables for 2026. Values in square brackets represent the number of planned deliverables reflected in [A/80/6 \(Sect. 6\)](#).